

■ Measurement Scavenger Hunt

Detailed Step-by-Step Lesson Plan

Lesson Overview

This lesson introduces young learners to the concept of **length** through a hands-on Measurement Scavenger Hunt. Students explore informal (non-standard) units of measurement — **hand spans**, **finger widths**, and **footsteps** — before comparing objects using vocabulary such as *longer*, *shorter*, and *tallest*. Cultural context (the Indian 'Haath') grounds the lesson in real-world experience.

■ Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

1. Define **length** as the distance from one end to the other.
2. Compare two or more objects using the words **longer**, **shorter**, **taller**, **same length**.
3. Measure objects using **hand spans**, **finger widths**, and **footsteps**.
4. Record and **communicate** measurement results using complete sentences.
5. Connect informal measurement to **cultural heritage** (the Haath).

■ Materials Needed

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|-----------------------------|--|
| • Pencils, crayons, rulers | • Chalk and chalk box, duster |
| • Student notebooks / books | • Printed Hunt Cards (one per student) |
| • Whiteboard / blackboard | • Stickers or stamps (reward) |

SECTION 1: Hook / Warm-Up (5 Minutes)

Slide 2 — 'Let's Play: Guess the Longest!'

Step 1: Engage Curiosity

- Display three classroom objects on the board/desk: a **pencil**, **crayon**, and **ruler**.
- Ask: *"Which one do you think is the longest? Point to it!"*
- Repeat with: **duster vs. chalk box vs. chalk piece**.
- Accept all guesses — no wrong answers at this stage. Celebrate participation!

■ **Teacher Tip:** Use exaggerated gestures — hold objects up high, tilt your head as if thinking hard. This playful energy sets the tone for the entire lesson.

SECTION 2: Concept Introduction (10 Minutes)

Slide 3 — 'What is Length?'

Step 2: Introduce 'Length'

- Write the word **LENGTH** in large letters on the board.
- Say: *"Length is how long or tall something is from one end to the other!"*
- Draw a line on the board. Mark **START** and **END** with arrows.
- Ask a student to point to the 'start' and 'end' of their pencil.
- Reinforce: *"We always measure from one end... all the way to the other end!"*

Slide 4 — 'Let's Compare!'

Step 3: Teach Comparison Vocabulary

- Hold up a pencil and a crayon side-by-side, starting from the same base.
- Ask: *"Can you see which one goes further? That one is **LONGER**!"*
- Write on board: **LONGER | SHORTER | SAME LENGTH**.
- Do 2–3 quick comparisons with objects students can see clearly.

- Invite students to use the new vocabulary in a sentence.

Slide 5 — 'Our Measurement Words'

Word	Meaning	Example Sentence
Long / Longer / Longest	More length than another	The ruler is longer than the crayon.
Short / Shorter / Shortest	Less length than another	The chalk is shorter than the pencil.
Tall / Taller / Tallest	Height from bottom to top	Ravi is taller than Priya.

SECTION 3: Measurement Methods — Teacher Demonstration (15 Minutes)

Slides 6, 7, 8 — Hand Span · Fingers · Footsteps

Step 4: Method 1 — Hand Span

- Spread your hand wide on the whiteboard ledge or a large book.
- Say: *"Spread your fingers from thumb to little finger — that is your HAND SPAN!"*
- Walk along the notebook edge, marking each span.
- Count aloud: *"One... two... my notebook is 2 hand spans long!"*
- Students copy the action on their own notebooks at their desks.

Step 5: Method 2 — Finger Widths

- Hold your index finger flat against a pencil.
- Say: *"Place your finger at one end... move it along... count each finger width!"*
- Demonstrate counting to 3 finger widths across a short chalk piece.
- Let students try on their own eraser or chalk immediately.
- Reinforce: *"The smaller the object, the fewer finger widths it is!"*

Step 6: Method 3 — Footsteps

- Walk heel-to-toe from the classroom door to your chair in a straight line.
- Count aloud with the class: *"One, two, three... six footsteps!"*
- Say: *"From the door to my chair is 6 footsteps!"*
- Safety reminder: **Walk slowly. Keep hands free. No running.**
- Invite one student volunteer to repeat the walk and count.

Slide 9 — 'Did You Know? The HAATH!'

■ **Cultural Connection:** Long ago in India, cloth merchants measured fabric using their arm — from elbow to fingertip. This was called a '**HAATH**'. Ask students: *"Can you measure your arm from elbow to fingertip? That is one Haath!"* This connects informal measurement to Indian heritage and helps students see that measurement is a living, everyday skill.

Slide 10 — 'Watch Me Hunt!'

Step 7: Live Teacher Demonstration

- Pick up a notebook and pencil. Think aloud while measuring.
- Step 1 — Walk around and find something **LONGER** than your pencil (e.g. the ruler).
- Step 2 — Measure your notebook using **HAND SPAN**. Count carefully and say the number.
- Write your result on the board: *"My notebook = 2 hand spans"*.
- Say: *"Now it is YOUR turn to be measurement explorers!"*

SECTION 4: Student Scavenger Hunt Activity (20 Minutes)

Slides 11 & 12 — 'Your Measurement Scavenger Hunt!'

Step 8: Distribute Hunt Cards and Explain the Task

- Give each student a **Hunt Card** (printed worksheet with three tasks).
- Read the three tasks aloud together as a class:
- ■ Task 1 — Measure your **pencil** in finger widths.
- ■ Task 2 — Measure your **book** in hand spans.
- ■ Task 3 — Measure the **classroom door** in footsteps.
- Demonstrate how to write the answer: *"My pencil = ____ finger widths."*
- Set a timer. Remind students to be **careful, quiet, and methodical**.

Step 9: Students Perform the Hunt

- Students work **individually** or in pairs (your choice).
- Circulate the room — prompt with questions:
- *"Did you start at one end?" "Count again slowly!" "Is the ruler longer or shorter than your pencil?"*
- Encourage students to say their findings aloud as they write.
- Give a 2-minute warning before time is up.

■ **Hunt Card Reference (what students fill in):**

Task	Object	Measuring Unit	My Answer
1	Pencil	Finger widths	____ finger widths
2	Book / Notebook	Hand spans	____ hand spans
3	Classroom desk / door	Footsteps	____ footsteps

SECTION 5: Share, Compare & Discuss (7 Minutes)

Slides 13 & 14 — 'What Did You Find?' and 'Let's Check!'

Step 10: Class Sharing Circle

- Ask 4–5 students to share their results using the sentence frame:
- *"I measured my _____. It is ____ hand spans long. It is longer/shorter than _____."*
- Write two different students' results on the board for the same object.
- Ask: *"Priya says 2 hand spans. Arjun says 3 hand spans. Why might they be different?"*
- Guide discovery: **Different hand sizes give different numbers** — this is why we need standard units later!

Step 11: Interactive Check — Ruler vs Crayon

- Show Slide 14: display a long ruler and a short crayon.
- Say: *"Stretch your arms wide if the RULER is longer!"* (Students stretch.)
- Confirm: *"Yes! The ruler is LONGER. The crayon is SHORTER."*
- Ask one more: hold up two student pencils of different lengths.
- Let a student volunteer answer and explain their reasoning.

SECTION 6: Lesson Wrap-Up & Homework (3 Minutes)

Slide 15 — 'You Are Measurement Explorers!' & Slide 16 — 'Try This at Home!'

Step 12: Celebrate and Consolidate

- Display Slide 15. Say: *"Well done, measurement explorers!"*
- Ask three recall questions rapidly:
- ■ *What is length?* → Distance from one end to the other.
- ■ *Name one word we use to compare lengths.* → Longer / Shorter / Same.
- ■ *What are our three ways to measure?* → Hand span, finger widths, footsteps.

- Give a sticker or stamp to every student who completed the Hunt Card!

Step 13: Assign Homework (Slide 16)

- Ask students to measure **3 things at home** using hand spans and finger widths.
- Suggested objects: a **vegetable** (cucumber or beans), their **tiffin box**, their **chappal**.
- Students write their answers in their notebook and bring it the next day.
- Ask a family member to help and to check the counting!

SECTION 7: Differentiation & Assessment Strategies

Learner Group	Support / Extension Strategy
Needs Support	Pair with a buddy; provide a pre-drawn hand-span strip to lay beside objects; reduce hunt to 2 tasks.
At Grade Level	Complete all 3 tasks independently; use the full sentence frame when sharing.
Advanced	Measure 2 extra objects of their choice; compare results with a partner and order 4 objects from shortest to longest.
Students with Mobility Needs	Substitute footstep task with counting hand spans across a long strip of paper laid on the desk.

■ Formative Assessment Checklist

#	Observable Behaviour	Look For
1	Identifies which object is longer/shorter	Correct pointing and vocabulary
2	Measures without gaps or overlaps	Continuous, touching spans
3	Counts measuring units accurately	Matches count to actual units placed
4	Uses measurement vocabulary correctly	Uses longer, shorter, same in sentences
5	Completes Hunt Card with answers	All 3 tasks attempted and recorded

QUICK REFERENCE: Lesson Timeline

Time	Section	Slide(s)	Key Teacher Action
0–5 min	Hook / Warm-Up	Slide 2	Guess the Longest game
5–15 min	Concept Introduction	Slides 3–5	Teach length + vocabulary
15–30 min	Teacher Demonstration	Slides 6–10	Model 3 measuring methods
30–50 min	Student Scavenger Hunt	Slides 11–12	Students measure & record
50–57 min	Share & Discuss	Slides 13–14	Sharing circle + check
57–60 min	Wrap-Up & Homework	Slides 15–16	Celebrate + assign HW

■ **Remember:** *The goal of this lesson is not precision — it is **curiosity**. Celebrate every measurement attempt. Different hand sizes giving different answers is a feature, not a bug — it plants the seed for why standard units (cm, m) matter later!*